Black Rock Shooter: The Game (PSP)

Unused and cut features found in the game's own code

These turned up while porting the game to PC, by reading its executable and its scripts. Everything below is in the game's files and nothing in the finished game can reach it. "Cut" is our reading of that: the code cannot say when or why a thing was dropped, and we have not checked whether any of it has been written up elsewhere. Numbers such as 0xF58A8 are places in the decrypted executable of the US release.

1. A dash on the field

The main find. Besides the dodge of a battle (Circle, which the game has), the executable holds a second dash for the field, the part of the game where she runs about a map between battles.

- **What it would do.** Holding Square and pushing the stick would have her dash the way she faces, with an animation of its own (number 0x1D), a glowing aura about her (effect 999018) and a sound (0x38).
- **Its cost.** Each dash takes 5 from a gauge of hers, and a tunable figure says how soon another may follow.
- **Why it can never happen.** The code that begins a dash from the pad is called only from inside a dash that is already going, so the first one never starts. And the gauge it spends is nought from the start of the game: the only thing that fills it is a kind of consumable item that no item in the game is.
- **What the player gets instead.** Square on the field brings up the map.

Part	Where	Note
Dash begins (her action 7)	0xF58A8, each frame 0xF8D70	moves her in status 2 the way she faces
What follows it (action 8)	0xF5B28, each frame 0xF5C94	
Square held and stick pushed	0xF77A4	called only from the two frames above
The dash's sound	0xF5890	sound 0x38 of the common bank
What fills the gauge	0x56854	a kind of consumable no item is

2. Containers that only a dash would touch

The maps place 23 containers (the scripts' own name is KONTENA). Each is solid, has a small turning sign at its foot, and carries a switch (setting 94) that tells the game: when it looks for what she has walked into, count this thing only while she is dashing (0x118330 asks for action 7). With no dash, walking into a container does nothing. It looks as though they were once to be broken open by dashing into them. What a button press does with them we have not followed.

3. A gun emplacement that no map has

The script library every map shares has three functions named HOUDAI_SEARCH_RANGE, HOUDAI_ATTACK_RANGE and HOUDAI_ATTACK_PARAM ("houdai" is Japanese for a gun battery). Between them they set fifteen figures of a character: how far it looks for her, how far it shoots, and how it shoots. The engine has room for all fifteen (settings 97 to 111). No map calls any of the three, and there is no emplacement on any field.

4. A test event left in the data

Among the events that speak to her over the radio is one called FEVT_TEST_MSSK01. Seven of the 71 engine functions that events use are used by it alone. The game never plays it.

5. Smaller leftovers

- **A turn of the camera nothing asks for.** A switch of the field (flag 0x50) would turn the view over 30 frames towards a point over a character. Nothing sets it.
- **A sound for a destroyed character.** A character's script may name one (se_destroy); none does.
- **Two more field sounds.** A map could name sounds to be heard once she has moved a while in her status 2 (the dash's, and that of her leaps); no map names any.
- **Marks over characters.** Seven functions of the object that shows the "!" over an enemy are empty (0x46D60 to 0x46DB0): something it once did has been taken out.
- **Hooks nobody answers.** The system script asks every event for a function called update_async_time, and the engine asks every character's script for get_stat_anim; no script has either.
- **Switches that do nothing.** Setting 91 has no code behind it. Settings 71 and 95 are stored and never read. Setting 119 is set 1,187 times, with every change of a face, and never read.
- **Switches nobody uses.** Settings 83 to 87 and 93 work but no map sets them: 84 would put a shadow where its character stands, 93 would hide a character's sign.
- **SET_JUNK.** A library function for scattering junk about a map, which no map calls.
- **A second kind of message for records.** The challenges' script can say a thing in a panel as well as in a window; it never asks for the panel.

What the PC port does with these

Nothing: the port does what the game does, and the game does none of this. The dash could be rebuilt as an optional extra, but that would mean inventing what is missing (how it starts, and what fills its gauge), so it would be a reconstruction and not a restoration.

Written 9 October 2026 from the port's notes (docs/FIELD_NOTES.md has the detail and the addresses).